

Satsang Diksha

Swaminarayan Bhagwan etle ke sākshāt
Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj sarvane
param shānti, ānand ane sukh arpe. (1)

*Swāminārāyaṇah sākshād
Akshara-Purushottamaha;
Sarvebhyah paramām shāntim
ānandam sukham arpayet. 1*

May Swaminarayan Bhagwan, who is
Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj himself,¹
bestow ultimate peace, bliss and happiness
on all. (1)

1. Here, Swaminarayan Bhagwan and Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj are synonyms and refer to the one supreme entity – Parabrahman, Paramatma.

Ā deh muktinu sādhan chhe, keval bhognu
sādhan nathi. Durlabh ane nāshvant evo ā
deh vāramvār malto nathi. (2)

*Deho'yam sādhanam mukter
na bhoga-mātra-sādhanam;
Durlabho nashvarash-chā'yam
vāram-vāram na labhyate. 2*

This body is a means for *moksha*, not
merely a means for indulgence [in sense
pleasures]. Rare and perishable, this body
is not repeatedly attained. (2)

Laukik vyavahār to dehnā nirvāh māte
chhe. Te ā manushya janmanu param
lakshya nathi. (3)

*Laukiko vyavahāras-tu
deha-nirvāha-hetukaha;*

*Naiva sa paramam lakshyam
asya manushya-janmanaha. 3*

Personal and family activities are [only] for the sustenance of the body. They are not the ultimate objective of this human birth. (3)

Sarva doshone tālvā, brahma-sthitine pāmvā ane Bhagwanni bhakti karvā ā deh malyo chhe. Ā badhu satsang karvāthi avashya prāpta thāy chhe. Āthi mumukshuo sadāy satsang karvo. (4–5)

*Nāshāya sarva-doshāṇām
brahma-sthiter avāptaye;
Kartum Bhagavato bhaktim
asya dehasya lambhanam. 4*

*Sarvam idam hi satsangāl-
labhyate nishchitam janaihi;
Atah sadaiva satsangah
karaṇīyo mumukshubhihi. 5*

This body has been received to eradicate all flaws, attain the *brāhmic* state and offer devotion to Bhagwan. All this is certainly attained by practising satsang.² Therefore, *mumukshus* should always practise satsang. (4–5)

Tethi Parabrahma Swaminarayane ā lokmā sākshāt avtarine ā divya satsangni sthāpnā kari. (6)

*Satsangah sthāpitas-tasmād
divyo'yam Parabrahmaṇā;*

2. See verses 8–9 for a definition of 'satsang.'

*Swāminārāyaṇeneha
sākshād evā'vatīrya cha. 6*

For this reason, Parabrahman Swaminarayan himself manifested in this world and established this divine Satsang. (6)

Ā satsangnu jñān mumukshuone thāy evā shubh āshaythi 'Satsang Diksha' e nāmnu shāstra rachvāmā āve chhe. (7)

*Satsangasyā'sya vignānam
mumukshūṇām bhaved iti;
Shāstram Satsanga-Dīksheti
shubhā'shayād virachyate. 7*

The shastra titled 'Satsang Diksha' has been composed with the pure intent that *mumukshus* acquire the knowledge of this satsang. (7)

Satya evā ātmāno sang karvo, satya evā Paramatmano sang karvo, satya evā guruno sang karvo ane sach-chhāstrano sang karvo e satsangnu sāchu lakshan jānvu. Āvo divya satsang karnārā manushya sukhi thāy chhe. (8–9)

*Satyasya svātmanah sangah
satyasya Paramātmanaha;
Satyasya cha guroh sangah
sach-chhāstrāṇām tathaiva cha. 8
Vignātavyam idam satyam
satsangasya hi lakshaṇam;
Kurvan-nevam vidham divyam
satsangam syāt sukhī janaha. 9*

One should know that the true meaning of satsang is to associate with the *ātmā*,

which is true; to associate with Paramatma, who is true; to associate with the guru, who is true; and to associate with true shastras. One who practises this divine satsang becomes blissful. (8–9)

Dikshā etle dradh sankalp, shraddhāe sahit evo achal nishchay, samyak samarpan, priti-purvak nishthā, vrat ane dradh āshro. (10)

*Dīksheti draḍha-sankalpah
sa-shraddham nishchayo'chalaha;
Samyak samarpanam prītyā
nishṭhā vratam draḍhāshrayaha. 10*

‘Diksha’ means firm resolve, unwavering conviction coupled with faith, absolute

dedication, loving faith, observances and firm refuge. (10)

Ā shāstramā Parabrahma Sahajanand
Paramwatmae darshāvel āgnā tathā
upāsanāni paddhatine spasht rite janāvi
chhe. (11)

*Shāstre'smin gnāpitā spashtam
āgnopāsana-paddhatihi;
Paramātma-Parabrahma-
Sahajānanda-darshitā. 11*

The methods of āgnā and upāsanā revealed by Parabrahman Sahajanand Paramatma are clearly expressed in this shastra. (11)

Purusho tathā strīo sarve satsangnā
adhikāri chhe, sarve sukhnā adhikāri chhe

ane sarve brahmavidyānā adhikāri chhe. (12)

*Satsangā'dhikrutah sarve
sarve sukhā'dhi-kāriṇaha;
Sarve'rhā brahmavidyāyām
nāryash-chaiva narās-tathā. 12*

All males and females are entitled to satsang, all are entitled to happiness and all are entitled to *brahmavidyā*. (12)

Satsangmā ling-bhedthi nyun-ādhikpanu na ja samajvu. Badhā pot-potāni maryādāmā rahi bhakti vade muktine pāmi shake chhe. (13)

*Naiva nyūnādhikatvam syāt
satsange linga-bhedataha;
Sva-sva-maryādayā sarve
bhaktyā muktim samāpnuyuhu. 13*

In Satsang, superiority or inferiority should never be understood to be based on gender. All can attain *moksha* through devotion while observing the dharma prescribed for them. (13)

Sarva varnanā sarva strio tathā sarva purusho sadāy satsang, brahmavidyā ane mokshanā adhikāri chhe. Varnanā ādhāre kyārey nyun-ādhikbhāv na karvo. Sarva janoe potānā varnanu mān tyajine paraspar sevā karvi. Jātie karine koi mahān nathi ane koi nyun pan nathi. Tethi nāt-jātne laine klesh na karvo ne sukhe satsang karvo. (14–16)

*Sarva-varṇa-gatāh sarvā
nāryah sarve narās-tathā;*

*Satsange brahmavidyāyām
mokshe sadā'dhikāriṇaha. 14*

*Na nyūnā'dhikatā kāryā
varṇā'dhāreṇa karhichit;
Tyaktvā sva-varṇa-mānam cha
sevā kāryā mithah samaihi. 15*

*Jātyā naiva mahān ko'pi
naiva nyūnas-tathā yataha;
Jātyā klesho na kartavyah
sukham satsangam ācharet. 16*

All men and women of all castes are forever entitled to satsang, *brahmavidyā* and *moksha*. Do not attribute notions of superiority and inferiority based on *varna*. All persons should shun their ego based on their caste and serve one another. No one

is superior and no one is inferior by birth. Therefore, one should not quarrel based on caste or class and should joyfully practise satsang. (14–16)

Gruhastha tathā tyāgi sarve mokshanā adhikāri chhe. Temā nyun-ādhikbhāv nathi, kāran ke gruhastha ke tyāgi badhā Bhagwannā bhakto chhe. (17)

*Sarve'dhikāriṇo mokshe
gruṇas-tyāgino'pi cha;
Na nyūnā'dhikatā tatra
sarve bhaktā yatah Prabhoho. 17*

Householders and renunciants are all entitled to *moksha*. Between them neither is inferior or superior, because house-

holders and renunciants are all devotees of Bhagwan. (17)

Swaminarayan Bhagwanne vishe ananya,
dradh ane param bhakti mātē āshray-
dikshā mantra grahan kari satsang prāpta
karvo. (18)

*Swāminārāyaṇe'nanya-
draḍha-parama-bhaktaye;
Gruhītvā'shraya-dīkshāyā
mantram satsangam āpnuyāt. 18*

To offer singular, resolute and supreme devotion to Bhagwan Swaminarayan, one should receive the Ashray Diksha Mantra³ and affiliate with the Satsang. (18)

3. 'Ashray Diksha Mantra' refers to a specific mantra recited when one first takes refuge in Satsang.

Āshray-dikshā mantra ā pramāṇe chhe:

Dhanyo'smi purna-kāmo'smi
nishpāpo nirbhayah sukhi;
Akshara-guru-yogena
Swaminārāyan-āshrayat. (19)

Āshraya-dīkshā-mantrash-chaivam vidhaha:

Dhanyo'smi pūrṇakāmo'smi
nishpāpo nirbhayah sukhī;
Akshara-guru-yogena
Swāminārāyaṇā'shrayāt. 19

The Ashray Diksha Mantra is as follows:

Dhanyo'smi purna-kāmo'smi
nishpāpo nirbhayah sukhi;
Akshara-guru-yogena
Swaminārāyan-āshrayat.⁴ (19)

4. This mantra should be recited as written. The meaning ►

Mumukshu potānā ātmāni mukti māte
Sahajanand Shri Hari tathā Akshar-
brahma-swarup Gunatit guruno pritie ka-
rine āshro kare. (20)

*Āshrayet Sahajānandam
Harim Brahmā'ksharam tathā;
Guṇātītam gurum prītyā
mumukshuh svātma-muktaye. 20*

For the *moksha* of one's *ātmā*, a *mumukshu* should lovingly take refuge of Sahajanand Shri Hari and the Aksharbrahman Gunatit guru.⁵ (20)

of this mantra is as follows: "Having taken refuge in Swaminarayan Bhagwan through the association of the Aksharbrahman guru, I am blessed, I am fulfilled, I am without sins, I am fearless and I am blissful."

5. 'Gunatit guru' refers to the Aksharbrahman guru, who is beyond *māyā*.

Satsangno āshro kari sadāy kanthne vishe
kāshthni bevdi mālā dhāran karvi tathā
satsangnā niyamo dhāran karvā. (21)

*Kāshṭha-jām dvi-guṇām mālām
kanṭhe sadaiva dhārayet;
Satsangam hi samāshritya
satsanga-niyamāns-tathā. 21*

Upon taking the refuge of satsang, one should always wear a double-stranded wooden *kanthi* around the neck and accept the *niyams* of satsang. (21)

Ā sansārmā brahmaswarup guru vinā
jivanmā brahmavidyāno tattve karine
sākshātkār na thai shake. (22)

*Gurum Brahmaswarūpam tu
vinā na sambhaved bhaved;*

*Tattvato brahmavidyāyāh
sākshātkāro hi jīvane. 22*

In this world, *brahmavidyā* cannot be fully realized in life without the Brahmaswarup guru.⁶ (22)

Aksharbrahma guru vinā Paramatmano
uttam nirvikalp nishchay na thai shake
tathā potānā ātmāne vishe brahmabhāv
pan prāpta na thai shake. (23)

*Nottamo nirvikalpash-cha
nishchayah Paramātmanaha;
Na svātma-brahma-bhāvo'pi
Brahmā'ksharam gurum vinā. 23*

Without the Aksharbrahman guru,

6. 'Brahmaswarup guru' refers to the Aksharbrahman guru.

supreme, unwavering conviction (*nishchay*) in Paramatma cannot be attained and one's *ātmā* also cannot acquire *brahmabhāv*. (23)

Brahmaswarup guru vinā yathārth bhakti
pan na thai shake, param ānandni prāpti
na thāy ane trividh tāpno nāsh pan na
thāy. (24)

*Naivā'pi tattvato bhaktih
paramānanda-prāpaṇam;
Nā'pi trividha-tāpānām
nāsho Brahma-gurum vinā. 24*

Without the Brahmaswarup guru, perfect devotion also cannot be offered, ultimate bliss cannot be attained and the three

types of misery⁷ also cannot be eradicated.
(24)

Āthi sarva arthni siddhi kare tathā Para-
matmano anubhav karāve tevā pratyaksh
Aksharbrahma guruno āshro sadāy karvo.
(25)

*Atah samāshrayen-nityam
pratyaksham Aksharam gurum;
Sarva-siddhi-karam divyam
Paramātmā'nubhāvakam. 25*

Therefore, one should always take the
refuge of the manifest Aksharbrahman
guru, who enables one to attain all objec-
tives and experience Paramatma. (25)

7. The three types of misery are those that stem from other
beings, the deities and personal shortcomings.

Sarva satsangioe sarve dur-vyasanono
sadāy tyag karvo. Kāran ke vyasan anek
rogonu tathā dukhonu kāran bane chhe.
(26)

*Sarvam dur-vyasanam tyājyam
sarvaih satsangibhih sadā;
Aneka-roga-dukhānām
kāraṇam vyasanam yataha. 26*

All *satsangis* should always renounce all
harmful addictions, as addictions cause
numerous illnesses and miseries. (26)

Surā, bhāng tathā tamāku ityādi je je
padārtho mādak hoy te kyārey khāvā ke
pivā nahi tathā dhumrapānno pan tyāg
karvo. (27)

*Surā-bhangā-tamālādi
 yad yad bhaveddhi mādakam;
 Tad bhakshayet piben-naiva
 dhūmra-pānam api tyajet. 27*

One should never consume intoxicating substances, such as alcohol, bhang and tobacco. One should also refrain from smoking. (27)

Sarve stri tathā purushoe sarva prakārṇā
 jugārṇo tathā vyabhichārṇo tyāg karvo.
 (28)

*Pari-tyājyam sadā dyūtam
 sarvaih sarva-prakāarakam;
 Tyaktavyo vyabhichārash-cha
 nārībhih purushais-tathā. 28*

All women and men should never engage

in any form of gambling or adultery. (28)
 Satsangi janoe kyārey māns, māchhli, indā
 tathā dungli, lasan, hing na khāvā. (29)

*Mānsam matsyam tathāṇḍāni
 bhakshayeyur na karhichit;
 Palāṇḍum lashunam hingu
 na cha satsangino janāhā. 29*

Satsangis should never eat meat, fish, eggs, onions, garlic or hing. (29)

Pāni tathā dudh ityādi peya padārtho
 gālelā grahan karvā. Je khādyā vastu tathā
 pinā ashuddh hoy te kyārey grahan na
 karvā. (30)

*Pātavyam gālitam peyam
 jalam dugdhādikam tathā;*

*Khādyam pānam ashuddham yad
grahṇīyād vastu tan-nahi. 30*

One should consume water, milk and other drinkable items [only] after they have been filtered. Food items and beverages that are forbidden should never be consumed. (30)

Satsangioe chori kyārey na karvi.
Dharmane arthe pan chori kyārey na
karvi. (31)

*Chauryam na karhichit kāryam
satsangam āshritair janaihi;
Dharmārtham api no kāryam
chora-kāryam tu karhichit. 31*

Satsangis should never steal. Even for the

sake of dharma, one should never commit theft. (31)

Pushpa, falo jevi vastu pan tenā dhanini
parvāngi vagar na levi. Parvāngi vagar levu
te sukshma chori kahevay chhe. (32)

*Naivā'nya-svāmikam grāhyam
tad-anugnām vinā svayam;
Pushpa-falādyapi vastu
sūkshma-chauryam tad uchyate. 32*

One should never take even objects such as flowers or fruits without the consent of their owners. Taking without consent is a subtle form of theft. (32)

Kyārey manushya, pashu, pakshi, tathā
mākad ādik koi pan jiva-jantuoni hinsā na

karvi. Ahinsā param dharma chhe, hinsā
adharma chhe em Shruti-Smruti-ādi
shāstromā spasht kahevāmā āvyu chhe.
(33–34)

*Manushyāṇām pashūnām vā
matkuṇādesch-cha pakshiṇām;
Keshānchij-jīva-jantūnām
hinsā kāryā na karhichit. 33
Ahinsā paramo dharmo
hinsā tvadharma-rūpiṇī;
Shruti-smrutyādi-shāstreshu
sfuṭam evam prakīrtitam. 34*

One should never kill humans, animals,
birds and bugs or other insects and
creatures. The Shrutis, Smrutis and other
sacred texts clearly describe non-violence

as the highest dharma and violence as
adharma. (33–34)

Satsangioe yagnane arthe pan bakrā vagere
nirdosh prānioni hinsā kyārey na ja karvi.
(35)

*Yāgārtham apyajādīnām
nirdoshāṇām hi prāṇinām;
Hinsanam naiva kartavyam
satsangibhih kadāchana. 35*

Even for a *yagna*, *satsangis* should never
harm goats or any other innocent animals.
(35)

Yāgādi karvānā thāy tyāre Sampradaynā
siddhāntne anusarine hinsā rahit ja karvā.
(36)

*Yāgādike cha kartavye
siddhāntam sāmpradāyikam;
Anusrutya hi kartavyam
hinsā-rahitam eva tat. 36*

When *yagnas* are held, they should only be conducted without harming any beings and according to the Sampraday's principles. (36)

Yagnano shesh ganine ke pachhi devtānā naivedya rupe pan satsangioe kyārey māns na ja khāvu. (37)

*Matvā'pi yagna-shesham cha
vā'pi deva-niveditam;
Mānsam kadāpi bhakshyam na
satsangam āshritair janaihi. 37*

Satsangis should never eat meat, even if it

is considered to be the remnant of a *yagna* or sanctified by the deities. (37)

Koinu tādān kyārey na karvu. Apshabdo kahevā, apmān karvu ityādi koipan prakāre sukshma hinsā pan na karvi. (38)

*Kasyā'pi tādānam naiva
karaṇīyam kadāchana;
Apa-shabdā'pamānādi
sūkshma-hinsā'pi naiva cha. 38*

One should never strike another person. One should not swear, insult or commit other forms of subtle harm or injury. (38)

Dhan, sattā, kirti, stri, purush ityādini prāptine arthe tathā mām, irshā ke krodhe karine pan hinsā na karvi. (39)

*Sattā-kīrti-dhana-dravya-
strī-purushādikā'ptaye;
Mānershya-krodhatash-chā'pi
hinsām naiva samācharet. 39*

One should not commit violence to attain wealth, power, prestige or [to fulfil one's desire] for a man or woman or anything else. Also, one should not commit violence out of ego, jealousy or anger. (39)

Mane karine, vachane karine ke karme
karine hinsā karvāthi tenāmā rahelā
Swaminarayan Bhagwan dukhāy chhe. (40)

*Manasā vachasā vā'pi
karmanā hinsane krute;
Tat-sthito dukhyate nūnam
Swāminārāyaṇo arihi. 40*

Inflicting mental, verbal or physical violence pains Swaminarayan Bhagwan, who resides within that person. (40)

Ātmahatyā karvi te pan hinsā ja chhe.
Āthi padtu mukvu, gale tupo khāvo, jher
khāvu ityādi koi rite ātmahatyā kyārey na
karvi. (41)

*Ātma-ghāto'pi hinsaiva
na kāryo'tah kadāchana;
Patana-gala-bandhādyair
visha-bhakshādibhis-tathā. 41*

Suicide is also a form of violence. Therefore, never commit suicide by falling from heights, hanging oneself, consuming poison or any other means. (41)

Dukh, lajjā, bhay, krodh tathā rog ityādi
āpattine kārane, ke pachhi dharmane
arthe pan koie potāni ke anyani hatyā na
karvi. (42)

*Dukha-lajjā-bhaya-krodha-
rogādyāpatti kāraṇāt;
Dharmā'rtham api kashchiddhi
hanyān-na svam na vā param. 42*

No one should kill oneself or others out of
grief, shame, fear, anger or due to illness
and other adversities, not even for the
sake of dharma. (42)

Mumukshue tirthne vishe pan ātmahatyā
na ja karvi. Moksha ke punya pāmvanī
bhāvnāthi pan tirthne vishe āpghāt na ja
karvo. (43)

*Tīrthe'pi naiva kartavya
ātma-ghāto mumukshubhihi;
Naivā'pi moksha-puṇyāpti
bhāvāt kāryah sa tatra cha. 43*

A *mumukshu* should never commit suicide
even at a place of pilgrimage. One should
never commit suicide at pilgrimage places
even with the hope of attaining *moksha* or
merits. (43)

Bhagwan sarva-kartā chhe, dayālu chhe,
sarvanu rakshan karnārā chhe ane e ja sadā
mārā sarve sankatonā tālnārā chhe. (44)

*Bhagavān sarva-kartā'sti
dayāluh sarva-rakshakaha;
Sa eva nāshakah sarva-
sankatānām sadā mama. 44*

Bhagwan is the all-doer, compassionate and the protector of all; at all times, he alone is the resolver of all my adversities. (44)

Bhagwan je kare te sadāy sārā mātē hoy.
Temni ichchhā e ja mārū prārabdhā chhe.
Teo ja mārā tārak chhe. (45)

*Bhagavān kurute yaddhi
hitārtham eva tat sadā;
Prārabdham me tad ichchhaiva
sa eva tārako mama. 45*

Whatever Bhagwan does is always beneficial. His wish alone is my *prārabdh*. He alone is my liberator. (45)

Mārā vighno, pāp, dosh tathā durguno
avashya nāsh pāmshe. Hu avashya shānti,

param ānand ane sukh pāmish. (46)

*Nūnam nankshyanti me vighnāh
pāpa-doshāsh-cha dur-guṇāhā;
Nūnam prāpsyāmyaham shāntim
ānandam paramam sukham. 46*

My hindrances, sins, flaws and bad qualities will certainly be destroyed. I will surely attain peace, supreme bliss and happiness. (46)

Kāran ke mane sākshāt Akshar-
Purushottam Maharaj malyā chhe. Temnā
bale hu jarur dukhne tari jaish. (47)

*Yato mām militah sākshād
Akshara-Purushottamaha;
Nishchayena tarishyāmi
dukha-jātam hi tad balāt. 47*

This is because I have attained the manifest form of Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj. With his strength, I will surely overcome misery. (47)

Ā rite vichārnu bal rākhi āshrit bhakta
kyārey himmat na hāre ane Bhagwannā
bale ānandmā rahe. (48)

*Vichāryaivam balam rakshed
nā'shrito nirbalo bhavet;*

*Ānandito bhaven-nityam
Bhagavad bala vaibhavāt. 48*

With the strength of such thoughts, a devotee who has taken refuge never loses courage and remains joyous due to the strength of Bhagwan. (48)

Shāstramā tathā lokmā nishedh karyo hoy

tevā sthānone vishe kyārey thukvu nahi
tathā mal-mutrādi na karvu. (49)

*Shṭhīvanam mala-mūtrādi-
visarjanam sthaleshu cha;
Shāstra-loka-nishiddheshu
na kartavyam kadāchana. 49*

One should never spit, urinate or defecate in places prohibited by the shastras and society. (49)

Bāhya ane āntarik em sarva prakārni shuddhinu pālan karvu. Shri Harine shuddhi priya chhe ane shuddhivālā manushyani upar teo prasanna thāy chhe. (50)

*Shuddhih sarvavidhā pālyā
bāhyā chā'bhyantarā sadā;*

*Shuddhi-priyah prasādech-cha
shuddhi-mati jane arihi. 50*

One should observe all forms of external and internal purity. Shri Hari⁸ loves purity and is pleased with those who are pure. (50)

Satsangioe sadā surya ugyā purve jāgvu.
Tyār bād snānādik kari shuddh vastro
dhāran karvā. (51)

*Satsangibhih praboddhavyam
pūrvam sūryodayāt sadā;
Tatah snānādikam krutvā
dhartavyam shuddha vastrakam. 51*

Satsangis should always wake up before sunrise. After bathing and other morning

8. 'Shri Hari' is another name for Bhagwan Swaminarayan.

routines, they should put on clean clothes.
(51)

Tyār bād purva dishāmā athvā uttar
dishāmā mukh rākhi, shuddh āsan upar
besi nitya-pujā karvi. (52)

*Pūrvasyām uttarasyām vā
dishī krutvā mukham tataha;
Shuddhā'sanopavishṭah san-
nitya-pūjām samācharet. 52*

Thereafter, one should sit on a clean āsan and perform personal daily puja facing east or north. (52)

Swaminarayan mantrano jāp kartā tathā
gurunu smaran kartā kartā bhālne vishe
Bhagwanni pujāthi prasādi-bhut thayelā
chandan vade urdhva-pundra tilak karvu

ane kumkum vade chāndlo karvo tathā
chhāti ane banne bhujāo par chandanthi
tilak-chāndlo karvo. (53–54)

Prabhu-pūjopa-yuktena
chandananordhva puṇḍrakam;
Bhāle hi tilakam kuryāt
kumkumena cha chandrakam. 53

Uraśi hastayosh-chandram
tilakam chandanena cha;
Swāminārāyaṇam mantram
japaṁ kuryād gurum smaran. 54

While chanting the Swaminarayan mantra and remembering the guru, apply a U-shaped *tilak* made from *chandan* that has been sanctified by having been offered to Bhagwan and a kumkum *chandlo* to the

forehead. One should also apply a *tilak-chandlo* of *chandan* to the chest and both arms. (53–54)

Strioe Bhagwan tathā gurunu smaran
kartā bhālne vishe keval kumkumno
chāndlo karvo. Tilak na karvu. (55)

Kevalam chandrakah strībhiḥ
kartavyas-tilakam na hi;
Kumkuma dravyato bhāle
smarantībhir arim gurum. 55

While remembering Bhagwan and the guru, women should imprint only a kumkum *chandlo* to their foreheads. They should not apply a *tilak*. (55)

Tyār bād satsangne āshrit bhakte pujānā

adhikār māte Bhagwannā pratāpnu
chintvan kartā kartā ātmavichār karvo.
Prasann chitte ane bhaktibhāv-purvak
‘Aksharam aham Purushottam-dāsosmi’ e
pavitra mantranu uchchāran karvu.
Potānā ātmāne vishe Aksharbrahmani
vibhāvnā karvi ane shānt thai, ekāgra
chitte mānsi pujā karvi. (56–58)

*Tatah pūjā’dhikārāya
bhaktah satsangam āshritaha;
Kuryād ātma-vichāram cha
pratāpam chintayan arehe. 56*

*Aksharam-aham ityevam
bhaktyā prasanna chetasā;
Purushottama dāso’smi
mantram etam vadech-chhuchim. 57*

*Aksharabrahma rūpatvam
svasyā’tmani vibhāvayet;
Kuryāch-cha mānasīm pūjām
shānta ekāgra chetasā. 58*

Thereafter, to gain the privilege to perform puja, a devotee who has taken the refuge of satsang should meditate on their *ātmā* while contemplating upon the glory of Bhagwan. The sacred mantra ‘Aksharam-aham Purushottam-dāso’smi’⁹ should be recited with joy and devotion. One should identify one’s *ātmā* with Aksharbrahman and perform *mānsi puja* with a calm and focused mind. (56–58)

9. This mantra should be recited as written. The meaning of this mantra is as follows: “I am *akshar*, a servant of Purushottam.”

Bhagwan ane brahmaswarup guru ja moksha-dātā chhe. Temnā ja dhyān tathā mānsi pujā karvā. (59)

*Harir Brahma-gurush-chaiva
bhavato moksha-dāyakau;
Tayor eva hi kartavyam
dhyānam mānasa-pūjanam. 59*

Only Bhagwan and the Brahmaswarup guru can bestow *moksha*. Therefore, one should only meditate upon them and perform their *mānsi puja*. (59)

Tyār bād pavitra vastra upar chitra-pratimāonu sārī rite darshan thāy temā bhaktibhāv-purvak sthāpan karvu. (60)

*Sthāpayech-chitra-mūrtish-cha
shuchi vastropari tataha;*

*Darshanam syād yathā samyak
tathā hi bhakti-bhāvataha. 60*

Thereafter, devoutly place the pictorial *murtis* on a clean cloth in a way that one can easily do their darshan. (60)

Temā madhyamā Akshar tathā Purushottamni murti padhrāvavi etle ke Gunatitanand Swami tathā temnāthi par evā Maharajne padhrāvavā. (61)

*Madhye tu sthāpayet tatra
hyakshara-Purushottamau;
Swāminam hi Guṇātītam
Mahārājam cha tat param. 61*

In the centre, one should arrange the *murtis* of Akshar and Purushottam, that is, Gunatitanand Swami and the one who

transcends him, [Shriji] Maharaj. (61)

Tyār bād Pramukh Swami Maharaj
paryant pratyek guruoni murtio
padhrāvavi tathā pote pratyaksh sevyā hoy
te guruoni murtio padhrāvavi. (62)

*Pramukha-Swāmi paryantam
pratyeka guru-mūrtayaha;
Prasthāpyāh sevitānām cha
pratyaksham mūrtayah svayam. 62*

One should then place the *murtis* of each guru up to Pramukh Swami Maharaj and the *murtis* of the gurus whom one has personally served. (62)

Tyār bād āhvān shlok boline Maharaj tathā guruonu āhvān karvu. Be hāth jodi dāsabhāve namaskār karvā. (63)

*Āhvāna-shlokaṃ uchchārya
Harim cha gurum āhvayet;
Hastau baddhvā namaskāram
kuryāddhi dāsa-bhāvataha. 63*

Thereafter, one should invite [Shriji] Maharaj and the gurus by reciting the Ahvan Mantra.¹⁰ One should bow with folded hands and with *dāsabhāv*. (63)

Āhvān mantra ā pramāne chhe:

*Uttishtha Sahajānanda
Shri-Hare Purushottama;
Gunātītā'kshara brahmann-
uttishtha krupayā guro.*

*Āgamyatām hi pujārtham
āgamyatām mad-ātmataha;*

10. The Ahvan Mantra is a verse recited to invite Bhagwan into one's puja.

Sānnidhyād darshanād divyāt
saubhāgyam vardhate mama.

(64–65)

Āhvāna-mantrash-chaivam vidhaha:

Uttishṭha Sahajānanda

Shrī-Hare Purushottama;

Guṇātītā'kshara Brahmān-

uttishṭha krupayā guro. 64

Āgamyatām hi pūjārtham

āgamyatām mad-ātmataha;

Sānnidhyād darshanād divyāt

saubhāgyam vardhate mama. 65

The Ahvan Mantra is as follows:

Uttishṭha Sahajānanda

Shri-Hare Purushottama;

Gunātītā'kshara brahmān-
uttishṭha krupayā guro.

Āgamyatām hi pūjārtham

āgamyatām mad-ātmataha;

Sānnidhyād darshanād divyāt

saubhāgyam vardhate mama.^{II}

(64–65)

Tyār bād sthir chitte tathā mahimā sāthe
murtionā darshan kartā kartā Swami-
narayan mantrano jāp kartā mālā feravavi.
Tyār bād ek page ubhā rahi, hāth unchā

II. This mantra should be recited as written. The meaning of this mantra is as follows:

“O Sahajanand Shri Hari! O Purushottam! O Akshar-brahman Gunatit gurus! Please shower compassion [upon me] and awaken. Please come forth from my *ātmā*, to accept my puja. I become more blessed due to your divine presence and darshan.”

rākhi murtionā darshan kartā tapni mālā
feravavi. (66–67)

Mālām āvartayed mantram
Swāminārāyaṇam japan;
Mahimnā darshanam kurvan
mūrtinām sthira-chetasā. 66
Eka-pādotthito bhūtvā
mālām āvartayet tataha;
Tapasa ūrdhva-hastah san
kurvāṇo mūrti-darshanam. 67

Thereafter, with *mahimā* and a steady mind, one should perform *mālā* while chanting the Swaminarayan mantra and having darshan of the *murtis*. Afterwards, while continuing to do darshan of the *murtis*, one should stand on one leg with arms raised

and perform *tapni mālā*. (66–67)

Tyār bād sarvanā kendra samān ane vyāpak
evā Akshar-Purushottam Maharajne
sambhārtā pratimāoni pradakshinā
karvi. (68)

Tatah sanchintayan kuryād
Akshara-Purushottamam;
Vyāpakam sarva kendram cha
pratimānām pradakshināhā. 68

One should then perform *pradakshinās* of the *murtis* while contemplating upon Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj, who is pervasive and the focus of all. (68)

Tyār bād dāsbhāve purushoe sāshtāṅg
dandvat pranām karvā ane strioe besine
panchāṅg pranām karvā. (69)

Sāshṭāṅgā daṇḍavat kāryāh
praṇāmāh purushais-tataha;
Nārībhis-tūpavishyaiva
panchāṅgā dāsa-bhāvataha. 69

Thereafter, with *dāsbhāv*, males should perform *sāshṭāṅg dandvat pranāms* and females should sit and offer *panchāṅg pranāms*. (69)

Koi bhaktano droh thayo hoy tenā nivāranne arthe kshamāyāchnā-purvak prati-din ek dandvat pranām adhik karvo. (70)

Praṇāmo daṇḍavach-chaikah
kshamā-yāchana-pūrvakam;
Bhakta-droha-nivārārtham
kāryo'dhiko hi pratyaham. 70

One should perform an additional *dandvat*

pranām every day to seek forgiveness for hurting or harbouring ill-will towards another devotee. (70)

Tyār bād Swaminarayan mantrano jap kartā shubh sankalponi purti mātē divya-bhāv ane bhaktie sahit prārthanā (dhun) karvi. (71)

Divya-bhāvena bhaktyā cha
tad-anu prārthayej-japan;
Swāminārāyaṇam mantram
shubha-sankalpa-pūrtaye. 71

Then, to fulfil one's noble wishes, one should pray with *divyabhāv* and devotion while chanting the Swaminarayan mantra (dhun). (71)

Ā rite bhaktibhāve puajā karine punarā-

gaman mantrathi Akshar-Purushottam
Maharajne potānā ātmāne vishe padhrā-
vavā. (72)

*Bhaktitah pūjayitvaivam
Akshara-Purushottamam;
Punar-āgama-mantrena
prasthāpayen-nijātmani. 72*

After devoutly performing puja in this way, one should re-install Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj within one's *ātmā* by reciting the Punaragaman Mantra.¹² (72)

Punarāgaman mantra ā pramāne chhe:

*Bhaktyaiva divya-bhāvena
pujā te sam-anushthitā,*

12. 'Punaragaman Mantra' refers to the verse recited to conclude one's puja.

Gachchhā'tha tvam mad-ātmānam
Akshara-Purushottama. (73)

Punar-āgamana-mantrash-chaivam vidhaha:

*Bhaktyaiva divya-bhāvena
pujā te samanushthitā;
Gachchhā'tha tvam mad-ātmānam
Akshara-Purushottama. 73*

The Punaragaman Mantra is as follows:

*Bhaktyaiva divya-bhāvena
pujā te sam-anushthitā,
Gachchhā'tha tvam mad-ātmānam
Akshara-Purushottama.¹³ (73)*

13. This mantra should be recited as written. The meaning of this mantra is as follows:

“O Purushottam Narayan together with Aksharbrahman! I have performed your puja with devotion and *divyabhāv*. Now, please reside within my *ātmā*.”

Tyār bād satsangni dradhtā mâte jemā
Shri Hari tathā gurunā updesho ane
ādesho samāyā hoy tevā shāstranu roj
vānchan karvu. (74)

*Tatah satsanga-dārḍhyāya
shāstram paṭhyam cha pratyaham;
Ādeshāsh-chopadeshāsh-cha
yatra santi arer guroho. 74*

To strengthen one's satsang, one should
then daily read shastras that encompass
the teachings and instructions of Shri
Hari and the gurus. (74)

Tyār bād ādar ane namrabhāve bhaktone
pranām karvā. Ā rite pujā karine pachhi ja
potānā vyavahārnu kārya karvu. (75)

*Tad-anu praṇamed bhaktān
ādarān-namra-bhāvataha;
Evam pūjām samāpyaiva kuryāt
sva-vyāvahārikam. 75*

Thereafter, one should bow to devotees
with reverence and humility. Only after
performing puja in this way should one
engage in one's daily activities. (75)

Pujā karyā vinā jamvu nahi ne pāni vagere
pan na pivu. Pravāse gayā hoie to pan
pujāno tyāg na karvo. (76)

*Bhojyam naiva na peyam vā
vinā pūjām jalādikam;
Pravāsa-gamane chā'pi
pūjām naiva pari-tyajet. 76*

One should not eat food or even drink

water or other liquids without performing puja. One should not give up one's puja even during outings. (76)

Vruddhāvasthā, rogādi tathā anya āpattine
lidhe pote puja karvā asamarth hoy tene
anya pāse te puja karāvavi. (77)

*Vārdhakyena cha rogādyair
anyā'paddhetunā tathā;
Pūjārtham asamarthash-chet
tadā'nyaih kārayet sa tām. 77*

If one is incapable of doing puja because of old age, illness or other difficulties, one should have one's puja performed by another. (77)

Gharmā pratyek satsangie potāni svatantra puja rākhvi. Vali putra ke putrino

janma thāy te divasthi ja santān māte puja
lai levi. (78)

*Svīyapūjā svatantrā tu
sarvai rakshyā gruhe pruthak;
Janmano divasād eva
pūjā grāhyā sva-santatehe. 78*

Every *satsangi* in a household should keep their own separate puja. Moreover, one should acquire a puja for a child on the same day that he or she is born. (78)

Nitya pratyek bhakti, prārthanā tathā
satsang māte sarve satsangioe gharma
sundar mandir sthāpvu. Temā bhakti-
bhāve vidhivat Akshar-Purushottam tathā
param-parāmā āvel Gunatit guroo padhrā-
vavā. (79–80)

*Bhakti-prārthana-satsanga-
 hetunā prati-vāsaram;
 Sundaram mandiram sthāpyam
 sarvaih satsangibhir gruhe. 79
 Prasthāpyau vidhivat tasminn-
 Akshara-Purushottamau;
 Guravash-cha Guṇātītā
 bhaktyā paramparā-gatāhā. 80*

All *satsangis* should place a beautiful mandir within their homes where they can daily offer devotion, pray and practise satsang. Within the mandir, one should devoutly and ceremonially consecrate the *murtis* of Akshar-Purushottam and the Gunatit gurus of the tradition. (79–80)

*Sarve satsangi janoe prātah-kāle tathā
 sānje ghar-mandirmā pratidin ārti karvi
 ne sāthe stutinu gān karvu. (81)*

*Prātah prati-dinam sāyam
 sarvaih satsangibhir janaihi;
 Ārārtikyam vidhātavyam
 sa-stuti gruha-mandire. 81*

Every morning and evening, all *satsangis* should perform the *ārti* and sing the *stuti* before the *ghar mandir*. (81)

*Ārti samaye chittne sthir kari bhaktie
 sahit, tāli vagādtā ane uchch svare ‘Jay
 Swaminarayan Jay Akshar-Purushottam...’
 em ārtinu gān karvu. (82)*

*Uchchaih svarair Jaya Swāmi-
 nārāyaṇeti bhaktitaha;*

*Sa-tāli-vādanam geyam
sthireṇa chetasā tadā. 82*

While performing the *ār̥ti*, one should devoutly sing aloud the *ār̥ti* ‘Jay Swaminarayan, Jay Akshar-Purushottam...’ with a steady mind and while clapping. (82)

Je rasoi banāvi hoy te mandirmā dharāvavi ane prasādibhut thayel bhojan bhaktibhāv-purvak prārthanā boline pachhi jamvu. (83)

*Yaiva rasavatī pakvā
mandire tām nivedayet;
Uchchārya prārthanam bhaktyā
tatah prasāditam jamet. 83*

Offer whatever food has been prepared [to the *murtis*] in the *ghar mandir* and after

devoutly reciting prayers, eat the sanctified meal. (83)

Bhagwanne arpan karyā vagar anna, fal ke jalādi grahan na karvu. Jeni shuddhine vishe shankā hoy tevā annādi Bhagwanne na dharāvavā ane na jamvā. (84)

*Haraye'narpya na grāhyam
anna-fala-jalādikam;
Shuddhau shankitam annādi
nā'dyāñneshe nivedayet. 84*

One should not consume foods, fruits, water and other items without first offering them to Bhagwan. Foods and other items that may be impure should not be offered to Bhagwan nor should they be eaten. (84)

Ghar-mandirmā besine bhāve karine sthir
chitte kirtan, jap ke smruti vagere potāni
ruchi anusār karvu. (85)

*Kīrtanam vā japam kuryāt
smrutyādi vā yathā-ruchi;
Gruha-mandiram āsthāya
bhāvatah sthira-chetasā. 85*

While sitting in front of the *ghar mandir*,
one should, with devout feelings and con-
centration, sing kirtans, chant and engage
in *smruti* or other acts of devotion
according to one's preferences. (85)

Gharnā sabhyoe bhegā thai roj ghar-sabhā
karvi ane temā bhajan, goshti tathā
shāstronu vāchan ityādi karvu. (86)

*Sambhūya pratyaham kāryā
gruha-sabhā gruhasthitaihi;
Kartavyam bhajanam goshtih
shāstra-pāṭhādi tatra cha. 86*

Family members should gather daily for
ghar sabhā and engage in bhajan, discus-
sions, scriptural reading and other devo-
tional activities. (86)

Shri Harie shuddh upāsana-bhaktinā pos-
han ane rakshan mātē mandir nirmān-rup
bhaktinu pravartan karyu. Ane Bhagwan-
ni jemaj temnā uttam bhakta evā
Aksharbrahmani Bhagwanni sātē sevā
karvā mātē āgnā kari. (87–88)

*Shuddhopāsana-bhaktim hi
poshayitum cha rakshitum;*

*Bhaktim mandira-nirmāṇa-
rūpām prāvartayaddharihi. 87*

*Tathaivā'gnāpayām āsa
sevārtham Hariṇā saha;
Tasya chottama-bhaktasya
tasyevaivā'ksharasya cha. 88*

Shri Hari inspired the creation of mandirs as a form of devotion to foster and protect pure *upāsanā* and bhakti. He instructed that, along with Bhagwan, one should also serve his supreme devotee, Aksharbrahman, in the very same manner that one serves Bhagwan. (87–88)

Aksharbrahma Bhagwannā uttam bhakta chhe, kāran ke teo nitya māyāpar chhe ane

*nitya Bhagwanni sevāmā ramamān hoy
chhe. (89)*

*Vartata uttamo bhakto
Brahma Bhagavato'ksharam;
Nityam māyā-param nityam
ari-sevāratam yataha. 89*

Aksharbrahman is Bhagwan's supreme devotee because he eternally transcends *māyā* and is forever engrossed in Bhagwan's service. (89)

Te āgnāne anusarine sarvanu kalyān thāy te hetuthi divya mandironu nirmān bhaktibhāvthi karvāmā āve chhe ane tenā madhya khandmā Purushottam Bhagwanni murtini sāthe Aksharbrahmani murti pan vidhivat sthāpvāmā āve chhe. (90-91)

*Mandirāṇām hi nirmāṇam
 tad-āgnām-anusrutya cha;
 Divyānām kriyate bhaktyā
 sarva-kalyāṇa-hetunā. 90*

*Purushottama-mūrtyā tad-
 madhya-khaṇḍe yathā-vidhi;
 Sahitam sthāpyate mūrtir
 Aksharasyā'pi Brahmanaha. 91*

To fulfil this ordinance and to grant *moksha* to all, divine mandirs are devoutly constructed and the *murti* of Aksharbrahman is also ceremoniously consecrated with Purushottam Bhagwan in the central shrines [of these mandirs]. (90–91)

Ej rite ghar ādi sthalone vishe karelā mandirōmā pan madhyamā hammeshā Akshar-

brahma sahit Purushottam Bhagwanne
 prasthāpit karvāmā āve chhe. (92)

*Evam eva gruhādyeshu
 kruteshu mandireshvapi;
 Madhye prasthāpyate nityam
 sā'ksharah Purushottamaha. 92*

Similarly, Aksharbrahman and Purushottam Bhagwan are also always consecrated in the central shrines of mandirs in homes and other places. (92)

Sarve satsangioe savāre, sānje athvā potānā
 anukul samaye pratidin bhaktie karine
 samipe āvel mandire darshane javu. (93)

*Prātah sāyam yathā-kālam
 sarva-satsangibhir janaihi;*

*Nikaṭam mandiram gamyam
bhaktyā darshāya pratyaham. 93*

Daily, in the morning, evening or at another convenient time, all *satsangis* should devoutly go to a nearby mandir for darshan. (93)

Sarve *satsangi* nar-nārioē sadāy je rite potānā dharmani rakshā thāy te ja rite vasto dhārvā. (94)

*Yathā sva-dharma-rakshā syāt
tathaiva vastra-dhāraṇam;
Satsangi-nara-nārībhih
karaṇīyam hi sarvadā. 94*

All *satsangi* men and women should always dress in a manner that safeguards their dharma. (94)

Satsangni dradhtā māte dar athvādiye samip āvel mandirmā ke mandalmā sabhā bharvā javu. (95)

*Satsanga-draḍhatārtham hi
sabhārtham antike sthitam;
Gantavyam prati-saptāham
mandiram vā'pi maṇḍalam. 95*

To strengthen one's *satsang*, one should attend the weekly assemblies held at a nearby mandir or centre. (95)

Aksharādhīpati Swaminarayan Bhagwan sākshāt Paramatma Parabrahma Purushottam Hari chhe. (96)

*Swāminārāyaṇah sākshād-
Aksharādhīpatir-Harihi;*

Paramātmā Parabrahma

Bhagavān Purushottamaha. 96

Swaminarayan Bhagwan, the sovereign of Akshar, is the manifest form of Paramatma Parabrahman Purushottam Hari. (96)

E ekaj āpnā sadā param upāsya ishtadev chhe. Temni ja ananya bhāve sadā bhakti karvi. (97)

Sa ekah paramopāsya

ishṭa-devo hi nah sadā;

Tasyaiva sarvadā bhaktih

kartavyā'nanya-bhāvataha. 97

He alone is forever our *ishtadev* worthy of supreme *upāsana*. One should always offer singular devotion to him only. (97)

Gunatitanand Swami sākshāt sanātan Aksharbrahma chhe. E Aksharbrahmani paramparā āje pan virājmān chhe. (98)

Sākshād Brahmā'ksharam Swāmī

Guṇātītah sanātanam;

Tasya paramparā'dyā'pi

Brahmā'ksharasya rājate. 98

Gunatitanand Swami is the manifest form of the eternal Aksharbrahman. This Aksharbrahman *paramparā* is manifest even today. (98)

Sampradaymā Gunatitanand Swamithi ārambhāyel guru paramparāmā āvel pragat Aksharbrahma e ekaj āpnā guru chhe. (99)

*Guṇātīta-samārabdha-
paramparā-pratishṭhitaha;
Prakaṭā'kshara-brahmaikah
sampradāye'sti no guruhu. 99*

In the Sampraday's tradition of gurus that began with Gunatitanand Swami, only the present form of Aksharbrahman is our guru. (99)

Āpnā ishtadev ekaj chhe, guru ekaj chhe
ane siddhānt pan ekaj chhe em āpni sadā
ektā chhe. (100)

*Eka eveshṭa-devo nah
eka eva gurus-tathā;
Ekash-chaivā'pi siddhānta
evam nah ekatā sadā. 100*

Our *ishtadev* is the same, our guru is the same and our *siddhānt* is also the same – thus, we are always united. (100)

Brahmavidyā-rup, vaidik ane sanātan evā
divya Akshar-Purushottam siddhāntne
jānvo. (101)

*Siddhāntam suvijānīyād
Akshara-Purushottamam;
Brahmavidyātmakam divyam
vaidikam cha sanātanam. 101*

One should know [and realize] the divine Akshar-Purushottam *siddhānt*, which is Vedic, eternal and the form of *brahma-vidyā*. (101)

Jiva, ishwar, māyā, Aksharbrahma tathā
Parabrahma e pāñch tattvo sadāy bhinna

chhe, nitya chhe, satya chhe em mumukshue jānvu – em svayam Swaminarayan Bhagwane spasht siddhānt karyo chhe. (102–103)

*Jīvas-tatheshvarash-chaiva
māyā brahmā'ksharam tathā;
Parabrahmeti tattvāni
bhinnāni pancha sarvadā. 102
Nityān yatha cha satyāni
vigneyāni mumukshubhihi;
Swāminārāyaṇenaivam
siddhāntitam svayam sṛṣṭam. 103*

Mumukshus should realize that the five entities – *jīva*, *ishwar*, *māyā*, Aksharbrahman and Parabrahman – are forever distinct, eternal and true. Swaminarayan Bhagwan

himself established this clear *siddhānt*. (102–103)

Temā Akshar ane Purushottam e be sadāy māyāthi par chhe ane jivo tathā ishwaroni mukti temnā yogthi thāy chhe. (104)

*Teshu māyā-parau nityam
Akshara-Purushottamau;
Jīvānām-īshvarāṇām cha
muktis-tad-yogato bhavet. 104*

Among these entities, Akshar and Purushottam are the two who are eternally beyond *māyā*. *Jivas* and *ishwars* attain *moksha* by associating with them. (104)

Paramatma Parabrahma sadā Aksharbrahmāthi par chhe ane Aksharbrahma pan te Paramatmani nitya dāsbhāve sevā

kare chhe. (105)

Paramātmā Parabrahma
param Brahmā'ksharāt sadā;
Brahmā'pi sevate tam cha
dāsa-bhāvena sarvadā. 105

Paramatma Parabrahman is forever superior to Aksharbrahman. Furthermore, even Aksharbrahman eternally serves Paramatma with *dāsbhāv*. (105)

Bhagwan sadāy sarva-kartā, sākār, sarvopari chhe ane mumukshuoni mukti mātē hammeshā pragat rahe chhe. (106)

Sarva-kartā cha sākārah
sarvopari sadā Harihi;
Mumukshūṇām vimokshāya
prakaṭo vartate sadā. 106

Bhagwan is eternally the all-doer, with form, and supreme; he always remains manifest for the *moksha* of *mumukshus*. (106)

Aksharbrahma-swarup guru dvārā Bhagwan potānā sakal aishvaryo sahit, paramānand arptā thakā sadāy pragat rahe chhe. (107)

Brahmā'kshara-guru-dvārā
Bhagavān prakāṭah sadā;
Sahitah sakalaishvaryaiah
paramā'nandam arpayan. 107

Through the Aksharbrahman guru, Bhagwan always remains present with all of his divinity and bestows utmost bliss. (107)

Aksharbrahma gurune vishe dradh priti

ane ātmabuddhi karvi. Temne vishe pratyaksh Bhagwanno bhāv lavine bhaktie karine temni sevā tathā dhyān karvā. (108)

*Prītiḥ kāryā'tma-buddhish-cha
Brahmā'kshare gurau draḍhā;
Pratyaksha-Bhagavad-bhāvāt
sevyo dhyeyah sa bhaktitaha. 108*

One should foster intense love and ātmabuddhi for the Aksharbrahman guru. Believing the guru as the manifest form of Bhagwan, one should serve him and meditate upon him with devotion. (108)

Swaminarayan mantra divya, alaukik ane shubh mantra chhe. Swayam Shri Harie ā mantra āpyo chhe. Sarva bhaktoe teno jap karvo. Ā mantramā 'Swami' shabdathi

Aksharbrahmane samajvā ane 'Narayan' shabdathi te Aksharbrahmathi par evā Purushottamne samajvā. (109–110)

*Swāminārāyaṇo mantrō
divyash-chā'laukikah shubhaha;
Japyo'yam sakalair bhaktair
datto'yam ariṇā svayam. 109*

*Aksharam Brahma vigneḃyam
mantrē Swāmīti shabdataha;
Nārāyaṇeti shabdena
tat-parah Purushottamaha. 110*

The 'Swaminarayan' mantra is divine, beyond this world and auspicious. Shri Hari himself bestowed this mantra. All devotees should chant it. In this mantra, understand that 'Swami' refers to

Aksharbrahman, and ‘Narayan’ refers to Purushottam, who is superior to Aksharbrahman. (109–110)

Ā siddhānt Bhagwan Swaminarayane ā lokmā prabodhyo. Gunatit guruoe tenu digantmā pravartan karyu. Shastriji Maharaje tene murtimān karyo. Guruonā jivan-charitra-granthomā teni punah dradhtā karāvavāmā āvi. Ā siddhāntne guruhari Pramukh Swami Maharaje potānā hastāksharhi lakhi sthir karyo. Sākshāt guruharinā prasanghi ā siddhānt jivanmā prāpta kari shakay chhe. Te ā sanātan muktuprad siddhāntne ja divya ‘Akshar-Purushottam Darshan’ kahevāmā āve chhe. (111–114)

*Swāminārāyaṇeneha
siddhānto’yam prabodhitaha;
Gurubhish-cha Guṇātītair
digante’yam pravartitaha. 111*

*Yagnapurushadāsena
sthāpito mūrti-mattayā;
Guru-charitra-granthesu
punar ayam draḍhāyitaha. 112*

*Pramukha-guruṇā yo’yam
svīyā’ksharaih sthirī-krutaha;
Sākshād guroh prasangena
labhyate’yam hi jīvane. 113*

*Ayam eva sa siddhānto
mukti-pradah sanātanaha;
Uchyate darshanam divyam
Akshara-Purushottamam. 114*

Bhagwan Swaminarayan revealed this *siddhānt* in this world. The Gunatit gurus spread it throughout the world. Shastriji Maharaj enshrined it in the form of *murtis*. It was reaffirmed in the *jivancharitra* texts of the gurus. This *siddhānt* was securely established by *guruhari* Pramukh Swami Maharaj in his own handwriting. This *siddhānt* may be imbibed in one's life through the association of the manifest *guruhari*. It is this eternal and *moksha*-bestowing *siddhānt* that is known as the divine 'Akshar-Purushottam Darshan'. (III–II4)

Avā param divya siddhāntnu chintvan kartā kartā nishthāthi ane ānand-utsāh-purvak satsang karvo. (II5)

*Siddhāntam paramam divyam
etādrusham vichintayan;
Satsangam nishṭhayā kuryād
ānandotsāha-pūrvakam. 115*

While reflecting on such a supremely divine *siddhānt*, one should engage in satsang with conviction, joy and enthusiasm. (II5)

Tran dehthi vilakshan evā potānā ātmāne vishe brahmarupni vibhāvnā kari sadaiva Parabrahmani upāsanā karvi. (II6)

*Nijā'tmānam brahmarūpam
deha-traya-vilakshaṇam;
Vibhāvyopāsanam kāryam
sadaiva Parabrahmaṇaha. 116*

Identify one's *ātmā*, which is distinct from

the three bodies, as *brahmarup* and always offer *upāsanā* to Parabrahman. (116)

Aksharādhīpati Paramatmani bhakti sadā dharme sahit karvi. Kyārey dharme rahit bhakti na karvi. (117)

*Aksharādhīpater bhaktim
sa-dharmām ācharet sadā;
Dharmēṇa rahitām naiva
bhaktim kuryāt kadāchana. 117*

One should offer devotion to Paramatma, the sovereign of Akshar, while always upholding dharma. One should never perform bhakti without dharma. (117)

Bhaktinu ke jñānu ālamban laine ke koi parvanu ālamban laine pan manushyae adharmanu āchran na karvu. (118)

*Bhaktim vā gnānam ālambya
naivā'dharmam charej-janaha;
Api parva-vishesham vā'
lambya nā'dharmam ācharet. 118*

One should not behave immorally even under the pretext of devotion, wisdom or festivals. (118)

Parvane vishe pan bhāng, dāru vagerenu pān karvu, jugār vagere ramvu, gālo bolvi ityādi na karvu. (119)

*Bhangā-surādi-pānam vā
dyūtādi-kṛīḍanam tathā;
Gāli-dānādikam naiva
parvasvapi samācharet. 119*

Even during festivities, one should abstain from bhang, alcohol and other such sub-

stances, as well as gambling, swearing and other such activities. (119)

Parabrahma tathā Aksharbrahma sivāy
anyatra priti na hovi te vairāgya chhe. Te
bhaktinu sahāyak ang chhe. (120)

*Parasmād Brahmaṇo'nyasmin-
naksharād Brahmaṇas-tathā;
Prītyabhāvo hi vairāgyam
angam bhakteh sahāyakam. 120*

Vairāgya is to not have love for anything or anyone other than Parabrahman and Aksharbrahman. It serves to support bhakti. (120)

Nindā, lajjā, bhay ke mushkelione lidhe
kyārey satsang, Swaminarayan Bhagwan,

temni bhakti ane guruno tyāg na karvo.
(121)

*Nindā-lajjā-bhayā'padbhyah
satsangam na pari-tyajet;
Swāminārāyaṇam Devam
tad-bhaktim karhichid gurum. 121*

When faced with criticism, shame, fear or difficulty, one should never abandon satsang, Swaminarayan Bhagwan, devotion towards him, or the guru. (121)

Bhagwan ane bhakti sevā shuddhbhāve,
mārā motā bhāgya chhe em mānine potānā
moksha māte karvi. (122)

*Sevā Hareh-cha bhaktānām
kartavyā shuddha-bhāvataha;*

*Mahad-bhāgyam mamāstīti
matvā sva-moksha-hetunā. 122*

One should serve Bhagwan and his devotees with pure intentions, believing it to be one's great fortune and with the goal of attaining one's *moksha*. (122)

Satsang ane bhajan vinā vyarth kāl nirgamvo nahi. Ālas tathā pramād vagereno hammershā parityāg karvo. (123)

*Neyo na vyarthatām kālah
satsangam bhajanam vinā;
Ālasyam cha pramādādi
pari-tyājyam hi sarvadā. 123*

One should not let time pass wastefully without satsang or devotion. One should

always give up laziness and negligence. (123)

Bhajan kartā kartā kriyā karvi. Āgnā anusāre karvi. Ām karvāthi kriyānu bandhan na thāy, kriyāno bhār na lage ane kriyānu mām na āve. (124)

*Kuryāddhi bhajanam kurvan
kriyā āgnā'nusārataha;
Kriyā-bandhah kriyā-bhārah
kriyāmānas-tato na hi. 124*

One should perform tasks while engaging in devotion and according to *āgnā*. By doing so, one will not become attached to one's actions, be burdened by them or develop ego because of them. (124)

Sevā, kathā, smaran, dhyān, pathanādi

tathā bhagvat-kirtan vagerethi samayne
sufal karvo. (125)

*Sevayā kathayā smrutyā
dhyānena paṭhanādibhihi;
Sufalam samayam kuryād
Bhagavat-kīrtanādibhihi. 125*

One should fruitfully use time by performing *sevā*, listening to discourses, *smruti*, meditating, studying, singing kirtans of Bhagwan and engaging in other such activities. (125)

Satsangno āshro potānā durgunone tālvā,
sadgunone prāpta karvā ane potānā param
kalyān māte karvo. (126)

*Sva-dur-guṇān apā-kartum
sam-prāptum sad-guṇāns-tathā;*

*Satsangā'shrayaṇam kāryam
svasya parama-muktaye. 126*

One should take the refuge of satsang to rid oneself of flaws, acquire virtues and attain ultimate *moksha*. (126)

Swaminarayan Bhagwan tathā Gunatit
guruoni prasannatā prāpta karvā sadā
satsangno āshro karvo. (127)

*Prasannatām samāvāptum
Swāminārāyaṇa-Prabhoho;
Guṇātīta-gurūṇām cha
satsangam āshrayet sadā. 127*

One should forever take the refuge of satsang to attain the pleasure of Swaminarayan Bhagwan and the Gunatit gurus. (127)

Aho! Āpanne Akshar ane Purushottam
banne ahi ja malyā chhe. Temni prāptinā
kefthi satsangnā ānandne sadāy mānvo.
(128)

*Aho ihaiva nah prāptāv-
Akshara-Purushottamau;
Tat-prāpti-gauravān-nityam
satsang-ānandam āpnuyāt. 128*

O! We have attained both Akshar and
Purushottam here [in this life]. With the
joy of having attained them, one should
always relish the bliss of satsang. (128)

Sevā, bhakti, kathā, dhyān, tap tathā yātrā
ityādi sādhan karie te māne karine,
dambhe karine, irshāe karine, spardhāe
karine, dveshe karine ke pachhi laukik

falni ichchhāthi na ja karvu. Parantu
shraddhāe sahit, shuddhbhāvthi ane
Bhagwanne rāji karvāni bhāvnāthi
karvu. (129–130)

*Sevā-bhakti-kathā-dhyāna-
tapo-yātrādi sādhanam;
Mānato dambhato naiva
kāryam naivershyayā tathā. 129*
*Spardhayā dveshato naiva
na laukika-falechchhayā;
Shraddhayā shuddha-bhāvena
kāryam prasannatā-dhiyā. 130*

One should never perform *sevā*, devotion,
discourses, meditation, austerities, pil-
grimages and other endeavours out of
vanity, pretence, jealousy, competition,

enmity or for the attainment of worldly fruits. However, they should be performed with faith, pure intentions and the wish to please Bhagwan. (129–130)

Bhagwan tathā gurune vishe manushyabhāv na jovo. Kāran ke Akshar ane Purushottam banne māyāthi par chhe, divya chhe. (131)

Drashyo na mānusho bhāvo
Bhagavati tathā gurau;
Māyā-parau yato divyāv-
Akshara-Purushottamau. 131

One should not perceive human traits in Bhagwan or the guru, since both Akshar and Purushottam are beyond māyā and divine. (131)

Bhagwan tathā gurune vishe vishvās dradh karvo, nirbaltāno tyāg karvo, dhiraj rākhvi tathā Bhagwannu bal rākhvu. (132)

Vishvāsah su-draḍhī-kāryo
Bhagavati tathā gurau;
Nirbalatvam pari-tyājyam
dhāryam dhairyam arer balam. 132

One should develop firm faith in Bhagwan and the guru, renounce feebleness, have patience and derive strength from Bhagwan. (132)

Swaminarayan Bhagwannā lilā-charitronu shravan, kathan, vānchan, manan tathā nididhyāsan karvu. (133)

Kāryam lilā-charitrāṇām
Swāminārāyaṇa-Prabhoho;

*Shravaṇam kathanam pāṭho
mananam nidi-dhyāsanam. 133*

One should listen to, recite, read, reflect upon and repeatedly recall the incidents of Swaminarayan Bhagwan. (133)

Mumukshue pratyaksh Aksharbrahma guruno prasang sadā param priti ane divyabhāvthi karvo. (134)

*Prasangah parayā prītyā
Brahmā'kshara-guroh sadā;
Kartavyo divya-bhāvena
pratyakshasya mumukshubhihi. 134*

Mumukshus should always associate with the manifest Aksharbrahman guru with supreme love and divyabhāv. (134)

Aksharbrahma-swarup gurune vishe dradh priti e ja brāhmi sthiti tathā Bhagwannā sākshātkārne pāmvānu sādhan chhe. (135)

*Brahmā'kshare gurau prītir
dradhaivā'sti hi sādhanam;
Brahma-sthiteh pari-prāpteh
sākshāt-kārasya cha Prabhoho. 135*

Intense affection for the Aksharbrahman guru is the only means to attaining the brāhmic state and realizing Bhagwan. (135)

Aksharbrahma gurunā guno ātmasāt karvā māte tathā Parabrahmani anubhuti māte Aksharbrahma gurunā prasangonu sadāy manan karvu. (136)

*Brahma-guṇa-samāvāptyai
Parabrahmā'nubhūṭaye;*

*Brahma-guroh prasangānām
kartavyam mananam sadā. 136*

To imbibe the virtues of the Aksharbrahman guru and to experience Parabrahman, one should always reflect on the incidents of the Aksharbrahman guru. (136)

Man-karma-vachane guruharinu sadā
sevan karvu ane temne vishe pratyaksh
Narayan-swarupni bhāvnā karvi. (137)

*Manasā karmaṇā vāchā
sevyo Guruharih sadā;
Kartavyā tatra pratyaksha-
Nārāyaṇa-svarūpa-dhīhi. 137*

One should associate with one's *guruhari* through thought, word and deed and should realize him as 'Narayanswarup' –

the manifest form of Narayan [Parabrahman]. (137)

Satsangie kyārey bal-rahit vāt sām̐bhalvi
nahi ane karvi pan nahi. Hammeshā bal
bhareli vāto karvi. (138)

*Shruṇuyān-na vaden-nā'pi
vārtām hīnām balena cha;
Bala-pūrṇām sadā kuryād
vārtām satsangam āsthitaha. 138*

A *satsangi* should never listen to or speak discouraging words. One should always speak encouraging words. (138)

Preme karine tathā ādar thaki Brahma ane
Parabrahmanā mahimāni tathā temnā
sambandh-vālānā mahimāni vāto nirantar
karvi. (139)

*Vārtā kāryā mahimno hi
 Brahma-Parama-brahmaṇoho;
 Tat-sambandha-vatām chā'pi
 sa-sneham ādarāt sadā. 139*

With affection and reverence, one should continuously speak of the glory of Brahman and Parabrahman and the greatness of those who are associated with them. (139)

Mumukshue satsangione vishe suhrad-
 bhāv, divyabhāv tathā brahmabhāv rākhvā.
 (140)

*Satsangishu suhrad-bhāvo
 divya-bhāvas-tathaiva cha;
 Aksharabrahma-bhāvash-cha
 vidhātavyo mumukshuṇā. 140*

Mumukshus should keep *suhradbhāv*, *divya-
 bhāv* and *brahmabhāv* toward satsangis. (140)

Paramatma Parabrahma Swaminarayan
 Bhagwan, Aksharabrahma-swarup Gunatit
 guru, temne āpelā divya siddhānt tathā
 temnā āshrit bhaktono viveke karine sadāy
 paksh rakhvo. (141–142)

*Paramātma-Parabrahma-
 Swāminārāyaṇa-Prabhoho;
 Brahmā'kshara-svarūpasya
 Guṇātīta-guroḥ-tathā. 141*

*Tad-arpitasya divyasya
 siddhāntasya cha sarvadā;
 Bhaktānām tach-chhritānām cha
 paksho grāhyo vivekataha. 142*

With discretion, one should always keep

the *paksh* of Paramatma Parabrahman Swaminarayan Bhagwan, the Aksharbrahman Gunatit guru, the divine *siddhānt* they have imparted and the devotees who have sought their refuge. (141–142)

Bhagwan ane brahmaswarup guruni āgnānu sadāy pālan karvu. Temni anuvrutti jānine tene dradhpane anusarvu. Temni āgnā ālas vagere mukine pālvi, tarat pālvi; sadā ānand, utsāh ane mahimā sāthe temne rāji karvānā bhāvthi pālvi. (143–144)

*Āgnām Bhagavato nityam
Brahma-gurosh-cha pālayet;
Gnātvā tad-anuvruttim cha
tām evā'nusared dradham. 143*

*Tad-āgnām pālayet sadya
ālasyādi vihāya cha;
Sānandotsāha-māhātmyam
tat-prasāda-dhiyā sadā. 144*

One should always obey the commands of Bhagwan and the Brahmaswarup guru. One should realize their inner wishes and firmly abide by them. Their instructions should be followed without laziness, immediately, and always with joy, enthusiasm, *mahimā* and an eagerness to please them. (143–144)

Pratidin sthir chitte antardrashti karvi ke hu ā lokmā shu karvā avyo chhu? Ane shu kari rahyo chhu? (145)

*Antar-drashtish-cha kartavyā
 pratyaham sthira-chetasā;
 Kim kartum āgato'smīha
 kim kurve'ham iheti cha. 145*

With a composed mind, one should introspect every day: “What have I come to accomplish in this world and what am I doing?” (145)

‘Aksharrup thaine hu Purushottamni bhakti karu’ em potānā lakshyanu chintan ālas rākhyā vagar roj karvu. (146)

*Samprāpyā'kshara-rūpatvam
 bhajeyam Purushottamam;
 Pratyaham chintayed evam
 svīya-lakshyam atandritaha. 146*

“Having attained oneness with Akshar, I offer devotion to Purushottam.” In this manner, one should reflect on one’s goal each day without laziness. (146)

Ā Swaminarayan Bhagwan sarva-kartā-hartā chhe, sarvopari chhe, niyāmak chhe. Teo mane ahi pratyaksh malyā chhe. Āthi ja hu dhanya chhu, param bhāgyashālī chhu, krutārth chhu, nishank chhu, nish-chint chhu ane sadā sukhi chhu. (147–148)

*Kartā'yam sarva-hartā'yam
 sarvopari niyāmakaha;
 Pratyaksham iha labdho me
 Swāminārāyaṇo arihi. 147*

*Ata evā'smi dhanyo'ham
 parama-bhāgyavān aham;*

*Krutārthash-chaiva nihshanko
nishchinto'smi sadā sukhī. 148*

Swaminarayan Bhagwan is the all-doer,¹⁴ supreme entity and controller. I have his association here in person. For this very reason, I am joyous, greatly fortunate, fulfilled, without doubts and worries, and forever blissful. (147–148)

Ā rite Paramatmani divya prāptinu,
mahimānu tathā temni prasannatānu
chintan darroj sthir chitte karvu. (149)

*Evam prāpter mahimnash-cha
pratyaham pari-chintanam;
Prabhoh prasannatāyāsh-cha
kāryam sthireṇa chetasā. 149*

14. Creator, sustainer and destroyer.

In this way, with a composed mind, one should reflect daily on one's divine attainment of Paramatma, his greatness and [attaining] his pleasure. (149)

Potānā ātmāne tran deh, tran avasthā
tathā tran gunthi judo samji teni Akshar-
brahma sāthe ektāni vibhāvnā pratidin
karvi. (150)

*Deha-traya-tryavasthāto
gnātvā bhedaṁ guṇa-trayaṁ;
Svātmano Brahmaṇaikatvam
prati-dinam vibhāvayet. 150*

Realizing one's ātmā to be distinct from the three bodies,¹⁵ the three states,¹⁶ and

15. Three bodies: *sthul* (gross), *sukshma* (subtle) and *kāraṇ* (causal).

16. Three states: *jāgrat* (waking), *swapna* (dream) and *sushupti* (deep sleep).

the three qualities,¹⁷ one should every day believe oneself as being one with Akshar-brahman. (150)

Darroj jagatnā nāshvant-panānu
anusandhān karvu ane potānā ātmāni
nityatā tathā sachchidānand-panānu
chintvan karvu. (151)

*Pratyaham anusandheyā
jagato nāsha-shīlatā;
Svātmāno nityatā chintyā
sach-chid-ānanda-rūpatā. 151*

Daily, one should reflect on the impermanent nature of the world and on one's *ātmā* as eternal and *sachchidānand*. (151)

17. Three qualities: *sattvagun*, *rajogun* and *tamogun* – the three qualities of *māyā*.